

Unit 5: Communication

What you need to know: This unit covers how the internet is used to communicate and share files with others globally.

- **Email**

- **What it is:** Short for "Electronic Mail," it is a method of exchanging digital messages between people over the internet.
- **Study Tip:** Think of it exactly like sending a traditional letter through the post office, but it arrives instantly and costs nothing per message.

- **Email Account Creation**

- **What it is:** The process of signing up with an email provider (like Gmail, Outlook, or Yahoo) to get your own unique digital address (e.g., student@gmail.com).
- **Study Tip:** Just like you need a mailbox at your house to receive physical mail, you need an email account to receive digital mail.

- **CC & BCC**

- **What they are:** Two special fields used when sending an email.
 - **CC (Carbon Copy):** Sends a copy of the email to someone else. Everyone who receives the email can see who is in the CC list.
 - **BCC (Blind Carbon Copy):** Sends a copy, but *hides* that person's email address from all other recipients.
- **Study Tip:** Use **CC** when you want to keep someone in the loop (like a manager). Use **BCC** when you are emailing a large group of strangers and want to protect their privacy by hiding their addresses from each other.

- **Attachments**

- **What it is:** A computer file (like a Word document, a photo, or a PDF) sent along with an email message.
- **Study Tip:** If an email is the "envelope," an attachment is the photo or document you physically stuff inside that envelope before sealing it. Remember, email providers usually have a size limit for attachments (e.g., 25 MB).

- **Cloud Storage**

- **What it is:** A model of storing your digital data on multiple remote servers over the internet instead of your computer's local hard drive.
- **Study Tip:** Think of it like renting a digital storage locker. Services like Google Drive or Dropbox let you save files online, meaning you can access them from any computer or phone in the world as long as you have internet.

- **Video Conferencing**

- **What it is:** A live, visual connection between two or more people residing in separate locations for the purpose of communication.
- **Study Tip:** This brings together the hardware you learned about in Unit 2 (webcams and speakers) and the internet to create virtual meeting rooms. Examples include Zoom, Microsoft Teams, and Google Meet.